

Dong Kyu Lee

UX Strategist & Designer based in Munich, Germany

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PROFILE

As a UX strategist and designer with 20+ years shaping user-centered products across finance and commerce, I translate research into measurable outcomes and build UX strategy, governance, and design processes from the ground up. My career spans Seoul, Hong Kong, and now Munich, working across cultures in Korean and in English.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategy & Research: UX Strategy · Design Research · Service Design · UX Governance · Design Ops · Information Architecture · Mentoring & Lecturing

Design & Delivery: Interaction Design · Prototyping · Usability Testing · Design Systems · Figma · Adobe Suite

Domains: Fintech & Digital Banking · E-commerce / Live Commerce · Consumer IoT · AI-driven design automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance UX Consultant & Designer

05/2023 – Present

Independent Contractor (UX strategy and design consulting for startups and public-sector clients, with a focus on AI-driven design automation)

- Led end-to-end experience and service design for a public-sector education programme, defining the user journey across digital touchpoints, print collateral, and on-site guided experiences.
- Mentor start-up teams on UX strategy and product design (NextGen Project, Ministry of Employment & Labor / Konkuk University) and lecture on UX for a Konkuk University Business School programme.

Senior Manager, Live Commerce UX

01/2021 – 04/2023

Coupang · Coupang Media Group, Seoul

- Directed all UX design, framework, and research for Coupang's live and VOD commerce platform across customer, creator, and vendor apps; owned UX for Coupang video advertising.
- Led a cross-functional team of three designers and one researcher.
- **+14% purchase conversion (CVR)** and a 10 pp drop in viewer drop-off by introducing real-time purchase and cart alerts, engagement signals, and a recommended-products drawer inside the live stream.

Senior Product UX Design Manager

10/2018 – 12/2020

HSBC · Retail Banking & Wealth Management, Hong Kong

- Led UX and UI design for a straight-through digital account-opening journey, enabling new-to-bank customers to open an account with no branch visit across Asia Pacific.
- Designed a dual-market onboarding journey for Hong Kong and mainland China, embedded within WeChat for Chinese residents.

UX Strategist & Designer

09/2014 – 09/2018

Samsung Card · UX Team, Seoul

- **+25% conversion and +12% click-through** on the Samsung Card homepage renewal, simplifying a dense information architecture around one-click access and layered in personalized content to be consistent across mobile and desktop.
- Devised UX strategy and interaction design for e-commerce and new financial services, including Direct Auto, the first service in Korea to let customers finance a car with a credit card in a few clicks.
- Established UX governance for Samsung Card's digital services.

Project Leader & Design Strategist

01/2004 – 08/2014

LG Electronics · Design Center (UX Lab, Design Management, Home Entertainment, Corporate Design)

- Developed the UX scenario for LG's first all-in-one smart-home IoT app (fridges, washers, vacuums, TVs) launched at CES 2014, UX for robotic vacuums (shipped 2013), and a next-generation home-robot prototype.
- Founded the UX Lab's strategy, roles, and core UX process; built and operated corporate UX identity and governance.
- **50%+ efficiency gain** from UI/GUI governance across a 500-person design org; established the 2010 "Design Core Process."

EDUCATION

Master of Science & Bachelor of Science, Industrial Design · *Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST)*

2004 & 2002

High School Diploma · *South Island International School, Hong Kong*

1997

PATENTS & PORTFOLIO

- Two US patents: cleaning device control (US 20160278593 A1) and image-information projection control (US 20170295406 A1).
- Full case studies (Coupang Live, Samsung Card renewal) with problem, hypothesis, prototype, and measured outcome at dkmakes.com.